requests to your app, while a process manager, such as systemd, monitors your apps for crashes and restarts it as appropriate.

As the reverse proxies aren't necessarily on the same server as your app, they can't be used to restart your app if it crashes. Instead, you need to use a process manager such as systemd to monitor your app. If you're using Docker, you typically use a container orchestrator such as Kubernetes (https://kubernetes.io) to monitor the health of your containers.

Running ASP.NET Core applications in Docker

Docker is the most commonly used engine for containerizing your applications. A *container* is like a small, lightweight virtual machine, specific to your app. It contains an operating system, your app, and any dependencies for your app. This container can then be run on any machine that runs Docker, and your app will run exactly the same, regardless of the host operating system and what's installed on it. This makes deployments highly repeatable: you can be confident that if the container runs on your machine, it will run on the server too.

All the major cloud vendors have support for running containers, either standalone or as part of an orchestration service. For example, in Azure, you can run containers in Azure App Service, Azure Container Instances, Azure Container Apps, and Azure Kubernetes Service. One advantage of containers is that you can easily use the same container in all these services or even move to a different cloud provider, and your app will run the same.

ASP.NET Core is well suited to container deployments, but moving to Docker involves a big shift in your deployment methodology and may or may not be right for you and your apps. If you're interested in the possibilities afforded by Docker and want to learn more, I suggest checking out the following resources:

- *Docker in Practice*, 2nd ed., by Ian Miell and Aidan Hobson Sayers (Manning, 2019) provides a vast array of practical techniques to help you get the most out of Docker (http://mng.bz/nM8d).
- Even if you're not deploying to Linux, you can use Docker with Docker for Windows. Check out the free e-book *Introduction to Windows Containers*, by John McCabe and Michael Friis (Microsoft Press, 2017), at https://aka.ms/containersebook.